

FACT-FILLED AND THE MOST HAPPENING CURRENT AFFAIRS FROM AROUND THE WORLD

Robot nanny for kids

If you have seen American animated sitcom *The Jetsons*, you must be familiar with robotic maids, robotic teachers and other robotic devices. Here is something real and closer to what you saw in *The Jetsons*. Roboy, a super advanced robot, has tendons that make it move like humans.

Being developed by Swiss engineers, Roboy has been designed to look like a human. About ten different institutes have collaborated on the project to make Roboy humanoid a success.

Engineers are also developing a soft skin for the bot. The team wants Roboy to help kids in their daily lives and become their nanny of sorts.

Ping-pong ball-sized robots

Nikolaus Correll, a US-based researcher, has come up with a swarm of ping-pong ball-sized robots that are claimed to be better than one big machine at accomplishing various tasks like cleaning up huge oil spills and sensing danger.

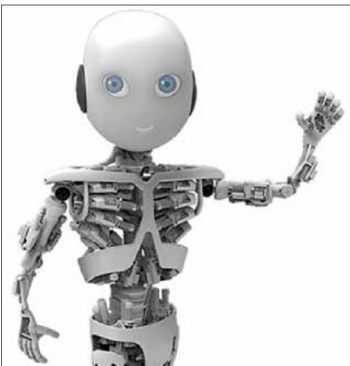
Correll, an assistant professor at University of Colorado Boulder, believes that if one robot has the ability to accomplish a singular task, much more

could be achieved if there are hundreds of them—says a report by Phys.org.

Correll worked with his research team to develop a basic robotic building block. He aims to reproduce the basic robotic building block in large quantities to develop complex systems.

“The team created a swarm of 20 robots, each the size of a ping pong ball, which they call droplets. When the droplets swarm together, Correll said, they form a “liquid that thinks.” Similar to the fictional nanomorphs depicted in *Terminator* films, large swarms of intelligent robotic devices could be used for a range of tasks,” the report explained.

Correll plans to use the droplets to demo intelligent swarm behaviours like pattern recognition, sensor-based motion and adaptive shape change.



Robot nanny named Roboy

Brain-controlled robotic arm

Jan Scheuermann cannot use her limbs to feed herself, but she has been gifted with a robot arm that does things for her with the use of her mind.

According to a report by CNET, she is the first person in the world to demonstrate that people with severe handicap can work on a mind-controlled robot arm with seven axes of movement. Scheuermann was struck by spinocerebellar degeneration in 1996. A study on the brain-computer interface (BCI) linking Scheuermann to her prosthetic was published online in medical journal *The Lancet*. Training on the BCI allowed her to move an arm and manipulate objects for the first time in nine years, surprising researchers.

Said senior investigator Andrew Schwartz of the University of Pittsburgh's Pitt School of Medicine, “This technology, which interprets brain signals to guide a robot arm, has enormous potential that we are continuing to explore. Our study has shown us that it is technically feasible to restore ability; the participants have



Jan Scheuermann controlling her robotic arm with the help of brain implant